Messenger ad vs Instant Form ad

365 Aeration & Seeding · Meta ads · numbers as of Monday 19 October 2026 · internal

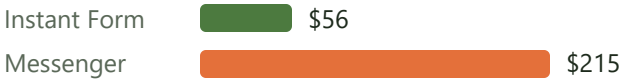
So far the Instant Form ad is doing better: about $56 per job it brought in, against about $215 for the Messenger ad. It cost less ($169 against $429), and three of its 21 leads became jobs. The Messenger ad started more conversations (36), but only two have become jobs so far, and most of those conversations never made it into Jen's list. This is five jobs and about a week of data, so read it as an early signal, not a verdict.

$598.69	5	$1,788	$119.74
spent on both ads	jobs booked from them	value of those jobs	cost per job, both ads together

Side by side

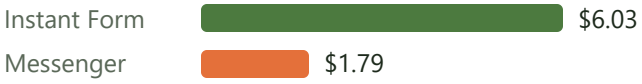
	Instant Form ad	Messenger ad	What it means
Spent	$169.28	$429.41	Messenger: lifetime, over 5 days ($100/day budget)
Leads / conversations	21 leads	36 conversations	a form lead gives name, phone and email; a conversation is someone who messaged the page
Cost per lead / conversation	**$8.06**	$11.93	Meta's own figure for each
Jobs booked	3	2	jobs on the app's schedule
Lead → job	**14% (3 of 21)**	6% (2 of 36)	Messenger: 2 of the 4 conversations that reached the app (50%)
Cost per job (acquisition cost)	**$56.43**	**$214.71**	spend ÷ jobs booked
Value of jobs booked	$1,021	$767	the prices on the jobs
Average job	$340	**$384**	Messenger jobs have been a little larger
Booked value per $1 spent	**$6.03**	**$1.79**	job value ÷ spend
Collected so far	$250	$299	the rest is due on jobs not done yet
Collected per $1 spent	**$1.48**	$0.70	cash in today, before the jobs still to come

Cost per job



Lower is better. Both are well under one job's value: the average job is $340–$384.

Booked value per $1 spent



Higher is better. Both ads have paid for themselves in booked work.

The jobs

Job	From	Price	Paid	Where it stands
Erik, Fri 16 Oct	Instant Form	$200	$200	done, paid in full
Jeremy, Tue 20 Oct	Instant Form	$482	$0	tomorrow; pays in person
Sreenivas, Fri 23 Oct	Instant Form	$339	$50	deposit paid, $289 left
Kirk, Mon 19 Oct	Messenger	$299	$299	paid in full in Square
Randy, Tue 20 Oct	Messenger	$468	$0	tomorrow; paying in the morning

What the Messenger ad is leaving on the table

36 conversations, about 4 in Jen's list. Only four Messenger conversations reached the app as leads (three more, Jim, Rob and Vernon, are tagged "Facebook" and may be Messenger too). That leaves roughly 29 to 32 people who messaged the page and are not being followed up in the pipeline. If even a few of them book, the Messenger ad's cost per job drops fast: at five jobs it would be $86, at eight $54, level with the form.

- **Log every Messenger conversation as a lead** (Quick quote, source Messenger) so none drops off, and so this comparison stays honest.
- **Split "Facebook" in Jen's ClickUp** into "Facebook Messenger" and "Facebook Form"; the app then sorts every lead into the right column by itself.
- **The Messenger ad spends about $86 a day** against the form's lower spend. Until its conversations are being worked, the form is the cheaper way to buy jobs.
- **Look again on Monday 26 October**, when Jeremy, Randy and Sreenivas are done and paid, and there is another week of both ads.

What the Messenger ad delivered on Meta

Measure (lifetime, 5 days)	Messenger ad
Views	20,824
People who saw it (viewers)	13,113
Post engagements	7,144
3-second video plays	6,725
Link clicks	340
Post reactions	45
Messaging conversations started	36
Cost per conversation	$11.93

The Instant Form screenshot showed leads, cost per lead and amount spent only. Views, reach and clicks for it were not on screen, so they are not compared here.

Where the numbers come from

Number	Source
Messenger: $429.41, 36 conversations, $11.93, views, engagements, clicks	Meta ad screenshot (Lifetime, 5 days), sent by Matthew 19 Oct
Instant Form: 21 leads, $8.06, $169.28	Meta Performance overview screenshot ("Activity history: All"), sent by Matthew 19 Oct. The date range was not shown; if this is not the ad's whole life, its spend and cost per job are understated
Jobs, prices, payments	the live app's schedule, 19 Oct; test entries left out
Which ad a job came from	Instant Form = leads in the form export imported 13–14 Oct (21 leads); Messenger = leads Jen marked Messenger. Russ was counted as Instant Form in the app, but ClickUp says Referral, so he is left out of both
Cost per job, value per $1, averages	worked out from the rows above

Not settled: whether Jim, Rob and Vernon came through Messenger (no jobs yet, so the job figures do not change); the Instant Form ad's exact date range. **Corrected:** Russ moved out of the Instant Form count (ClickUp: Referral). **Left out:** organic and referral jobs, and Kara's and Brian's earlier jobs, which came before the app.